

# Raconte

Spoken journaling. Private by construction. From [pianohouseproject.org](http://pianohouseproject.org)

## What it is

Raconte (French, “tell!”) is an app for iPhone and Mac for keeping a journal out loud. You press record and talk. The app keeps the recording and, as you speak, writes a transcript beside it on the phone itself. **The recording is what is kept.** The text is a helper: it can be corrected, re-done, or replaced later without touching the audio. Nothing is sent anywhere to make the words appear.

## What it is for

Between-session reflection, in the client’s own voice. A few minutes after a hard day, a walk, a thought they want to bring to the next session. The client owns the record: every recording and transcript belongs to them, on their own devices and in their own iCloud. Nothing is shared with anyone, including a therapist, unless the client chooses to share it. There is no clinician view, no dashboard, and no one on the other end reading along.

## Where your words go

1. **The recording stays on the client’s phone or Mac**, inside the app’s own private folder. Nothing is uploaded to make transcription work.
2. **Transcription happens on the device**, using Apple’s built-in speech recognition. Audio is never sent to a transcription service.
3. **Copies live only in the client’s own iCloud**, so their phone and Mac agree and a lost phone is not a lost journal. There is no Raconte server, no account to create, no analytics, and no third party in the path.
4. **The developer cannot read a client’s entries.** Apple encrypts the iCloud copy in transit and at rest. With Apple’s *Advanced Data Protection* turned on (a setting on the client’s Apple account), Apple itself cannot read it either. Without that setting, Apple holds the keys, as it does for most iCloud data.
5. **Nothing is auto-deleted.** Deleted entries wait thirty days in the trash. A damaged entry is set aside, never destroyed. Every recording and transcript can be exported, complete, as ordinary files the client keeps.

**Raconte is not a medical device and makes no HIPAA claim.** It is a personal journal a client keeps for themselves. It does not sign Business Associate Agreements, and it is not end-to-end encrypted by the app itself. Treat it as you would a paper journal the client owns.

## What it is not

- Not a therapist portal. There is no clinician login, no shared inbox, no way for anyone else to look in.
- Not an account. Nothing to sign up for; the app uses the iCloud identity already on the device.
- Not in the App Store yet. Raconte is in private testing through Apple’s TestFlight, by invitation. It needs iOS 26 or macOS 26.

## How Raconte compares

Voice-journal and therapy-adjacent apps a client might use instead. Short answers; the full notes with sources are in the survey.

Checked 2026-09-08; sources in the repo's survey.md. "Not stated" means the vendor's public pages do not say. Prices are US, at time of checking.

## Sharing with a therapist today

Raconte has no sharing feature. A client who wants to bring an entry to session can play it from the phone, or export. *About* → *Archive* → *Export archive...* writes a folder the client keeps: one sub-folder per entry with the audio file, a plain-text *transcript.md*, and a checksum list so the copy can be proven complete later. The client hands over the whole folder, or just one transcript, by whatever channel the two of you already trust.

Contact: [pianohouseproject.org](https://pianohouseproject.org) · source and documentation at [github.com/nicolovejoy/raconte](https://github.com/nicolovejoy/raconte)